

LakeHub

June 2025

Q2 2025 REPORT

ABOUT US

Lakehub was founded with the belief that investing in tech education and development of Africa's youth is essential for the growth and progress of the continent, and it is committed to providing the resources and support that these young people need to reach their full potential.

Through **Zone01 Kisumu**, we provide youths from all backgrounds with an opportunity to learn software development from scratch through peer-to-peer activities after which, they are guaranteed employment contracts of at least 3 years.

We are based in Kisumu, Kenya.

Mission

Our mission is to decentralize access to technology tools and resources, making them readily available to young people in underserved areas. By providing comprehensive tech education, mentorship programs, and access to cutting-edge technology, we equip young individuals with the skills and resources necessary to succeed in a digital economy

We are the only convener and trainer of young technologists in Kenya's lake region.





A message from our

SITE DIRECTOR

"I am guided each day by these three questions: 'What are you fixing?' 'What are you making?' and 'Who are you helping?" *— Juliana Rotich, Co-Founder of iHub, Kenya*

To quote Juliana Rotich, who immortalised the above words, allow me to reintroduce Zone01 Kisumu. We are an African-based tech company playing our part in fixing the alarmingly high unemployment rate of youths and women, which is at 70% in Kenya.

Brick by brick, mortar by mortar, we are training digital talents from underserved communities in superior coding skills and placing them in high-level tech roles in Backend, Frontend, Fullstack, Mobile, DevOps, UI/UX, Data Science, and Cybersecurity. With these skills, our developers are currently involved in MVP development for startups, building AI and blockchain solutions for companies, optimizing UI/UX for organizations, and scaling cloud infrastructure for enterprises.

Fifteen months into our 2-year training, we are excited to share that we have onboarded six companies that have hired 45 out of 92 Zone01 Kisumu developers to work on their projects. This means 43% of our talents have been placed in technical roles even before they complete their training, therefore validating the efficacy of our peer-to-peer software development curriculum and signature statement as being a top source of world-class software developers within the African continent. These companies are based in Kenya, Tanzania, the United States, Germany, and Australia. They include: Berrijam AI, BongoHub, Lantel Development, RevoWaste Technologies, Our Lady of Perpetual Support Kenya, Anza AMK Limited - Vuna. We are confident that as we cross the half-year mark, we will continue to attract more companies into our fold.

In addition to this, our staff and developers have attended and spoken at high-profile conferences across the globe in this quarter, including the recently concluded Maseno University AI Summit, Kenya Blockchain and Crypto Conference, Zetech University Innovation and Research Week, and the World CIO 200 Summit. We are truly re-coding the World with African Talent.

Finally, we continue to express our gratitude to all of you who continue to support our journey. Be assured that your stamp of approval has kept us in the game with our heads held high. Please be our good ambassadors out there. Thank you.

Caleb Nyoiro
Site Director, **Zone01 Kisumu**

QUARTER 2 IN NUMBERS

COHORT I

91	Apprentices on course to complete 18-month bootcamp
45	Current apprentices already placed in jobs, including...
17	women apprentices currently engaged in paid tech work.

COHORT II RECRUITMENT

74	Applicants participated in 1 month pre-selection stage bootcamps including...
15	women introduced to coding
9	youths selected to join Cohort II

CUMULATIVE IMPACT SINCE 2023

19,000+	Applications received so far including....
7,200	applications by women
724	Youths participated in 1 month pre-selection stage bootcamps with 100 being women
134	Youths on course for full time employment with 27 being women







OUR Q2 IMPACT

WE HAVE PLACED NEARLY HALF OF OUR COHORT I TRAINEES IN JOBS

According to the Federation of Kenya Employers, Kenya's youth population aged 18-34 years forms 35% of the Kenyan population. This demographic accounts for the **highest unemployment rate in Kenya, at 67%**. Every year, more than **1 million young Kenyans enter the labour market** without any skills, some having dropped out of school or completed school and not enrolled in any higher education institution. A good number who complete their university education, suffer from an acute lack of jobs.

Zone01 Kisumu offers these youths hope. Through our unique learning model that imparts coding skills, and our talent agency that places these youths in jobs, we continue to witness real impact that has so far unlocked career opportunities for young Kenyans.

Selection Piscines - Recruiting for Cohort II

In Q2, a further **74 youths** benefited from our 4-week intense training in Go language, bringing the total number of youths trained in 2025 to 200. An additional 80 are scheduled to begin their training in Go language starting June 27th, 2025.

"It's been fun. I've gained so much knowledge in the space of 1 month. To add to the technical coding skills, I've also sharpened my soft skills like collaboration and organizing my time" - *Moses Amani, Piscine VI candidate*

Further, we selected **9** more youths in Q2 (May 2025) to join our second cohort. The selected youths join the 25 we selected in Q1 to take part in our two-year tuition-free training at Zone01 Kisumu. **All 35 youths are on the path to full-time employment at Zone01 Kisumu**.

Partnerships Open Employment Paths for Apprentices

In Q2, we officially partnered with Lantel Development, RevoWaste Technologies, Our Lady of Perpetual Support Kenya, and Anza AMK Limited - Vuna to implement software solutions to their systems/operations. 45 apprentices are currently working on these companies' projects putting to practice the coding and problem -solving skills they've learnt from our peer-to-peer pedagogy. We are thankful to all our partners who've trusted our apprentices with these opportunities.



SOME ONGOING PROJECTS @ ZONE01 KISUMU



About BongoHub - BongoHub is a digital platform connecting creative professionals, change-makers, and organizations across East Africa. Originally conceived as a physical hub in Dar es Salaam, it evolved into a more impactful virtual network that transcends geographical limitations while strengthening existing regional initiatives.

What our Apprentices are building - Our team is developing BongoHub's online platform with a Ruby on Rails and React/Inertia technology stack, with core functionality focused on connecting people, projects, and places across the region. This digital infrastructure will enable BongoHub to scale its impact while maintaining the collaborative spirit that defines its community.

Project Lead: Josephine Opondo
Project Team: Andrew Osindo, Joab Owala, Abraham Maiko, Rodgers Kaunda, John Eliud

Feedback from BongoHub
"I am impressed by their professional approach and the motivation and creativity within the team! ❤️" - ***Angelika Farhan-Reimpell,*** *Bongo Hub, Founder*



About Berrijam AI - A platform that helps organizations understand their data, enabling non-programmers and business domain experts to easily find key insights for their specific priorities. Berrijam AI operates globally working with clients like Amazon Go

What our Apprentices are building - Our apprentices work supports Berrijam AI's ability to accelerate data analytics by 60x compared to traditional methods while maintaining the platform's core values of transparency and accessibility across healthcare, finance, and enterprise sectors.

Project Lead: Vincent Odhiambo
Project Team: Rodney Ochieng, Thadeus Ogondola, Stella Oiro, Moses Onyango, Valeria Muhembele, Wendy Akinyi, Raymond Caleb, Sheilla Juma, Seth Athooh

Feedback from Berrijam AI
"I saw a lot of potential when we collaborated on a hackathon. That potential has now grown grown to become proficient, delivering quality code to our AI project"- Avi Misra, Berrijam, Founder



About Sippar - Sippar is a comprehensive web-based petty cash management platform. It provides a streamlined system for tracking, approving, and reconciling petty cash transactions within organizations to improve transparency, reduce misuse, and streamline reimbursement processes.

What our Apprentices are building - Using Laravel, a popular PHP framework that handles the server-side logic and React, a JavaScript library, our apprentices have built an interactive user interface on the frontend. These two tools have also made the application fast and dynamic, especially for user input and real-time updates while keeping the backend secure and powerful.

Project Lead: Cynthia Oketch
Project Team: Antony Oduor Bravian Nyatoro Joel Amos Hezron Okwach

Feedback from Sippar
"The design and functionality is robust. I love it. Their ability to self-manage their project was great to see." - ***Lydiah Ojowi, Sippar Proprietor***

SOME ONGOING PROJECTS @ ZONE01 KISUMU



Anza AMK Limited
What our Apprentices are building - They are customizing open-source software projects to meet the specific needs of various clients. They are working on three major open-source platforms

Apache Fineract, an open-source core banking system that supports digital financial service providers. The team is customizing Fineract to fit unique client workflows and product offerings.

Fleetbase, a modern, open-source logistics and fleet management platform. The team is tailoring Fleetbase to address client-specific fleet tracking and logistics management needs.

Odoo is a popular open-source ERP platform used for managing sales, inventory, accounting, and more. Team is setting up and customizing Odoo modules to align with specific client workflows.

Project Lead: Adioz Eshitemi
Project Team: Maurice Mombewa, Granton Onyango



About 01 Talent Kenya - A software talent agency that is addressing the global need for top tech talent by transforming access to high-tech jobs.

What our Apprentices are building - A web-based platform that simplifies and accelerates the hiring of vetted software developers in Africa. Inspired by successful models such as Starnavi and Andela, the website will stand out by publicly displaying developer profiles. This will enable companies to view, assess, and hire developers directly through an easy "Hire Here" button that starts and completes the recruitment journey within the platform.

Project Lead: Denil Anyonyi

Project Team: Antony Oduor Bravian Nyatoro Joel Amos Hezron Okwach

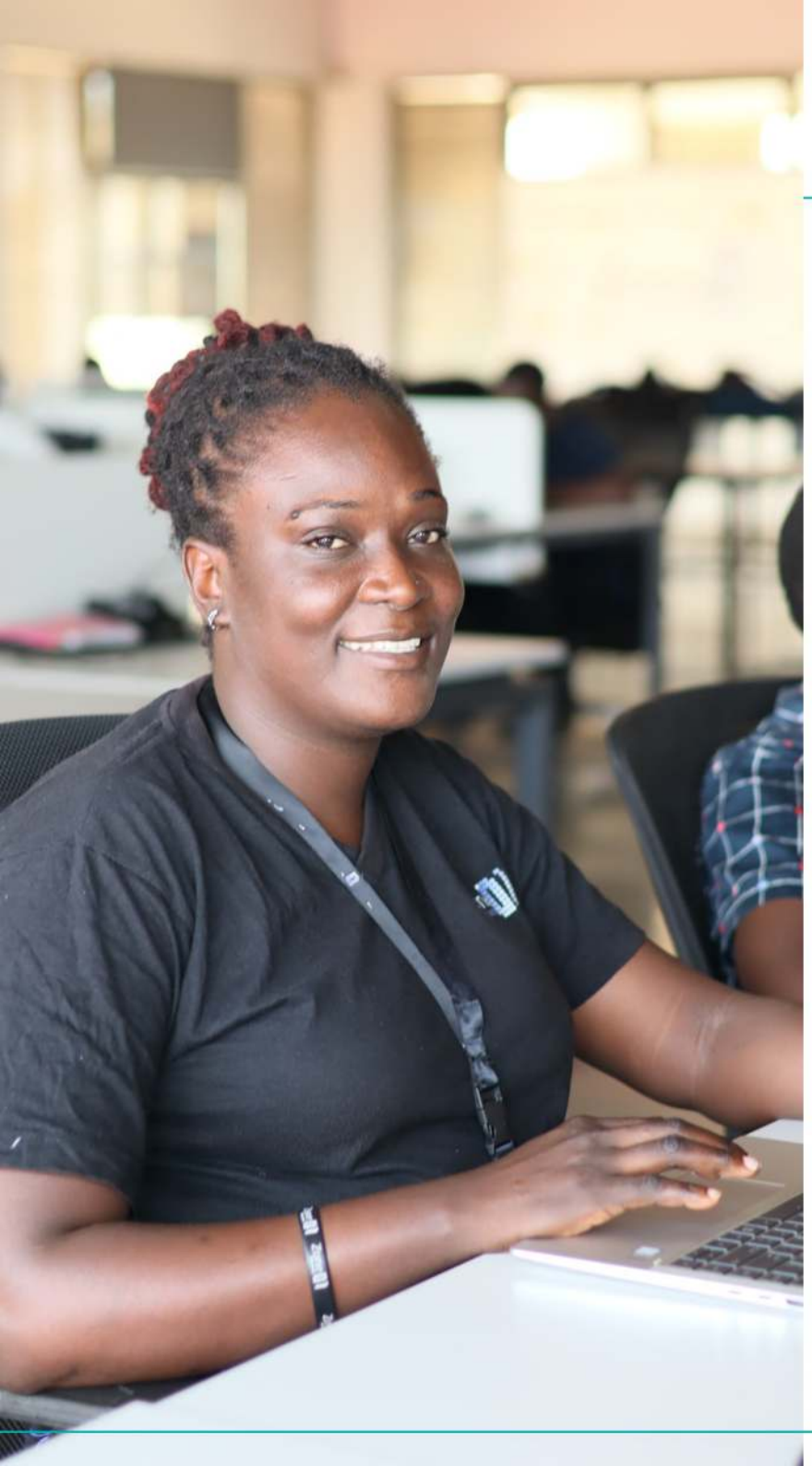
Feedback from 01 Talent Kenya
"The progress so far is positive. I can't wait to see what the final product looks like" - Chris Arunga, 01 Talent Kenya Project Lead











Impact Story

QUINTER A. OCHIENG'

From Limitations to Limitless Potential

Quinter is a devoted wife and a proud mother of a beautiful girl. For years, she balanced the daily responsibilities of raising her child and supporting her family, all while quietly nurturing a dream to become a software developer. Technology fascinated her. She often imagined herself building apps or solving problems through code. But despite her passion, the tech journey felt unreachable.

Like many others, the barriers to Quinter achieving her dreams were many. She lacked access to reliable internet, couldn't afford a laptop of her own, and didn't have anyone around her to guide her in the right direction. Online tutorials were often too advanced, and there were no local tech bootcamps in Western Kenya that she could learn from, until she heard about Zone01 Kisumu from one of her relatives.

The promise of Zone01 Kisumu seemed too good to be true, she says. Who in their right mind offers you tuition-free training in software development for two years, while supporting your financial needs through sustenance stipends and then eventually providing you with guaranteed employment? What was the catch? She wondered.

To her surprise, Quinter happily recounts, it was all true. Since she was selected to join Zone01 Kisumu, Quinter's life has undergone a dramatic change. For 15 months, she has been learning software development through our unique peer-to-peer, self-paced learning curriculum at LakeHub. What stood out most to her was the peer-to-peer learning model. "You're never alone," she says. "Even when it gets hard, there's always someone to help you figure it out." Quinter's pride is clear to see. She has mastered Go, Rust, Javascript, Python (Jango framework) and C, and is currently building a health management system called NoblMed. Who would blame her for walking with her head held high, confidently leading and coordinating her team members towards building a successful product.

Perhaps more importantly, Quinter's growth goes beyond the technical. She's far happier mum at home than she was before joining Zone01 Kisumu. With her financial worries settled, she can now hire a nanny to look after her baby as she continues to build her career in tech. Quinter's short term dream is to work with East Africa's biggest telco, Safaricom. Long-term, she sees herself working for Amazon. a dream that we will help her achieve.

To Quinter, Zone01 Kisumu has become more than just a coding program. She has found a community of coders who have lifted her from the periphery of tech industry and placed her firmly on the path to success. Quinter's story is a powerful reminder of what happens when untapped potential meets the right opportunity. **WATCH QUINTER'S IMPACT STORY**

ZONE01 KISUMU WOMEN LEADING NEW TECH COMMUNITIES

In Quarter 2, we have witnessed **Zone01 Kisumu** apprentices take up leadership roles in the wider tech community. These women have emerged as thought leaders, bringing together mostly young women to form vibrant learning and sharing communities in Kenya and beyond.



CHERYL OWALA

Polkadot Lead

Polkadot Kisumu is a new and growing blockchain developer community based in Kisumu, Kenya. Co-led by Cheryl Owala, Zone01 Kisumu Apprentice

I am thrilled to share that our community, Polkadot, serves as a local hub for Web3 education, hands-on workshops, and networking for developers, students, and blockchain enthusiasts.

Our Goal for the Polkadot Kisumu

The Polkadot Kisumu Bootcamp is designed to bridge local talent with global blockchain innovation. My main goal is to equip developers in Kisumu with practical Rust and ink! smart contract skills.

I am also preparing our community to actively contribute to the Polkadot ecosystem as builders, not just users. I want to ensure Kisumu has a presence in the broader Polkadot Africa movement championing African-led Web3 innovation.

I believe that Kisumu, like many other African tech hubs, holds untapped potential. By aligning with initiatives from Polkadot Africa and Web3wayAfrica, which champions blockchain adoption in grassroots areas, I aim to amplify local voices and innovations on a global Web3 stage.

-Cheryl Owala, Polkadot Lead and Zone01 Kisumu Apprentice



MALIKA ASMAN

STELLAR Development Foundation Nyanza region

Stellar Chain brings together developers working on Stellar, an open-source blockchain network designed to make financial systems more inclusive, fast, and affordable.

I stand proudly as the team lead for Stellar Chain in Nyanza, something that still surprises me when I think about how far I've come.

In a field often dominated by men, I've learned to lead, to speak up, and most importantly, to open doors for other women.

Why Stellar? Unlike many chains that focus on speculation, Stellar enables real-world tools like digital wallets, cross-border payments, and tokenized assets, that anyone can build or benefit from, even in underserved regions like Nyanza.

I know what it's like to feel unsure, unseen, or underestimated as a woman in tech so I've made it my mission to intentionally include and uplift other women.

I particularly proud of the Rust programming sessions and smart contract training, I've helped women gain the skills to not just participate, but build, deploy, and pitch real-world projects.

-Malika Asman - Stellar Chain Lead

LAKEHUB @ SKOLL WORLD FORUM 2025

Skoll World Forum 2025, the global gathering of social entrepreneurs, thought leaders, and philanthropists who collaborate to address global challenges, was the ideal space for LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu's leadership team to reconnect with some of our partners like Partners for Equity, Livelihood Impact Fund and Segal Family Foundation. Our leadership team Dorcas Owino and Caleb Nyoiro met future collaborators and fellow founders and leaders pushing boundaries across the globe. It was a true privilege being part of such a significant global movement transforming lives and communities. Dorcas also spoke at a panel organized by Manos Visibles panels.

> *"I had the incredible honour of speaking on some thought-provoking panels, including* ***From Talking to Accelerating Results****, where I shared my journey leading LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu. It was powerful to reflect on what it truly takes to scale impact and build tech-powered solutions that create real, lasting change."* - Dorcas Owino, Executive Director, LakeHub















ZONE01 KISUMU DIRECTOR HONOURED AT GLOBAL CIO 200, KENYA FORUM

Caleb Nyoiro, Zone01 Kisumu Director has been awarded by the prestigious Global CIO Forum/World CIO 200 Summit 2025 - KENYA Edition as a WINNER in the LEADER Category.

The recognition is a testament to Caleb's groundbreaking work in digital inclusion and youth empowerment relentless commitment to innovation, digital excellence, and leadership in the ever-evolving world of technology. The award celebrates those who have not only embraced transformation but have also led it from the front with bold vision and resilience.

The Kenya CIO 200 Summit 2025 brought together top decision-makers, IT professionals, and innovators committed to accelerating digital transformation across Kenya and the broader African continent.

To receive the award, Caleb was flanked by Zone01 Kisumu Talent Manager Christopher Arunga and Maurine Awuor, the County Government of Kisumu ICT Director. This award speaks to the impact that our programme has had with up to 17,000 youths reached in the past 2 years.



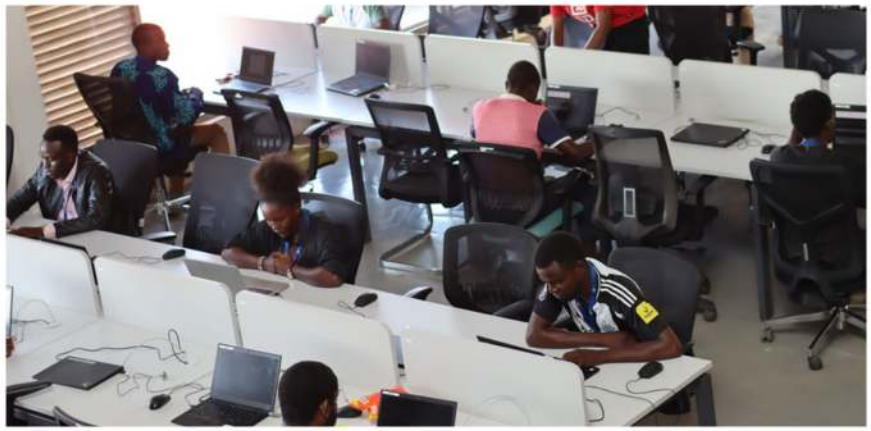
KEY DATES/EVENTS IN Q3

COHORT II SELECTION (PISCINE VI)

ZONE01 KISUMU ROTARY VTC

JUL 28

We continue with our recruitment process for Cohort II. We have seen increased appetite for our programme with more youth showing interest in joining Zone01 Kisumu.



COHORT II SELECTION (PISCINE VII)

ZONE01 KISUMU ROTARY VTC

SEP 1

Our final piscine to select the most promising canditates to join Zone01 Kisumu starts on September 1st 2025 at Rotary Vocational Centre



COHORT I

COMPLETE 18-MONTH TRAINING IN FULL STACK

SEP 7

The first Cohort completes their 18-month training as fullstack developers. The cohort began on April 8th 2024. All 92 apprentices will choose their specializations



LEARNING THROUGH EVENTS IN Q2



Digital Accessibility Training -
In honour of Global Accessibility Awareness Day (GAAD), Zone01 Kisumu staff hosted an enlightening training on Digital Accessibility conducted by Hope Women With Disabilities - CBO (HOWID) in collaboration with our partners United Cities and Local Governments of Africa (UCLG Africa).

Trainers Sherwood Gift, together with Hon Caroline Awuor Agwanda, a representative from the Office of the County Disability Advisor to the Governor, and Federico Batista Poitier, an expert in Disability Inclusive Urban Development and Human Rights from **UCLG Africa,** invited our staff to be more inclusive when building tech solutions.







Pint of Science Kenya 2025 -
This year's festival at LakeHub brought to light thought-provoking research, innovation, and community-driven solutions. The highlight was the rapid-fire 3-Minute Thesis that was dominated by researchers from Penn State University and Zone01 Kisumu who showcased diverse ideas aimed at solving local and global challenges.

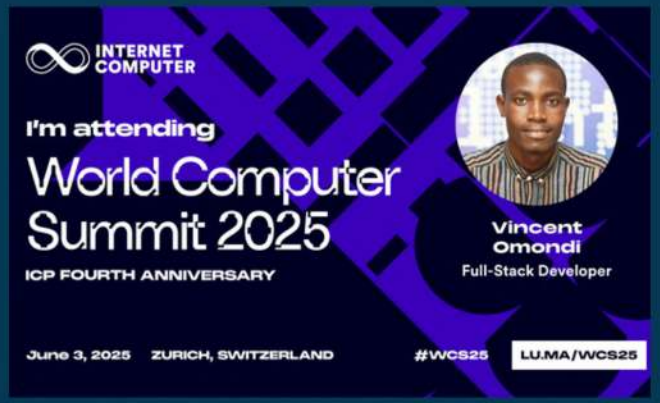
Other Training:
Crafting Winning Resumes by Dorcas Owino - Trained apprentices on writing great CVs to fit the job market.
Email Etiquette Training by Deril Ouko - Trained apprentices on professional email etiquette fit for workplaces
Strategic Personal Branding by Caleb Nyoiro - Apprentices trained on how to brand themselves professionally to gain an edge in the job market.





WE HAVE FACED CHALLENGES IN Q1

APPRENTICES MISS GLOBAL TECH CONFERENCES DUE TO FINANCES, VISA DENIAL



Vincent Omondi - Zone01 Kisumu Apprentice Full Stack Developer

"I was selected to attend the World Computer Summit 2025 held on June 3rd in Zurich, Switzerland, to mark the fourth anniversary of the Internet Computer Protocol (ICP). This summit brings together developers, researchers, and innovators working on decentralized internet technologies. I was invited based on my active contributions as an ICP Developer, particularly through my engagements in building decentralized apps on the Internet Computer and participating in community-driven innovation efforts.

Unfortunately, **I wasn't able to attend because I missed out on the limited travel sponsorship slots**. Attending the event would have required me to self-fund the trip, and at the time, I wasn't financially able to do so. This summit would have been an excellent opportunity to connect with ICP core teams, other developers, and potential collaborators. I'm very passionate about witnessing and contributing to a self-building internet and decentralized protocols. Attending such global developer summits remains a major personal goal, and I'd seize the chance to participate again in the future, especially as I continue to grow my impact in the ICP ecosystem."



Allan Robinson - Zone01 Kisumu Apprentice

"I was selected to attend GopherCon Europe 2025 in Berlin. This is a prestigious global event dedicated to Go programming language. I had been awarded a Diversity Scholarship, which fully covered my travel, accommodation, and participation costs. This opportunity arose from my active involvement in the Go community, including my participation in GopherCon Nairobi last year. I was really looking forward to networking with developers from around the world, attending high-level workshops, and representing Kenya's tech talent on a global stage.

Despite having all expenses covered and presenting strong documentation, **my visa application was denied by the German Embassy in Nairobi**. The reasons cited were concerns about financial means and doubts about my return, despite having full sponsorship and clear commitments back home. I felt misjudged and unfairly blocked from a well-earned opportunity.

I remain hopeful. The setback has only strengthened my resolve to grow, keep contributing to the Go community, and continue working towards making international opportunities like this one accessible and achievable."



ZONE01 KISUMU'S STACY DINA INVITED TO YOUTH ACTION PLAN EVALUATION IN PORTUGAL

It's not all doom and gloom though, Stacy Dina Adhiambo Owino, Zone01 Kisumu's Tech Software Developer and member of the Tech Team has been invited to a closed door working group session on the YAP evaluation by Knowledge Hub for Expertise on Youth (Soffreco) taking place in Lisbon, Portugal. Having worked as a board member of the EU's Youth Sounding Board (2021-2023) working on the Youth Action Plan and the Long Term Project (Community Building and engaging with young people)

MEET OUR TEAM

At the heart of **LakeHub** is a team dedicated to empowering youth through transformative tech education. Our team is committed to building a future where opportunity is driven by skills, innovation, and collaboration. We foster a supportive, inclusive environment that nurtures talent and drives lasting social impact across Western Kenya and beyond.



Dorcas Owinoh
Executive Director



Caleb Nyoiro
Site Director



Paul Oguda
Head of Tech



Chris Arunga
Talent Manager



Lydiah Ojowi
Finance Manager



Deril Ouko
Comms Lead



Bellah Oyucho
Tech



Stacy Dina
Tech



Alpha Omondi
Tech



Daisy Achieng
Comms Associate

FINANCIAL UPDATE Q2 2025

For the three months ended June 30th 2025, cash inflows totalled **$188,963**. Our total expenses for the same period were **$110,870** resulting in a net surplus of **$78,093**.

EXPENSES	TOTAL
Apprentice stipends and welfare	33,126
Online Subscription, Ads & Dues	4,946
Rentals and utilities	21,041
Repairs, maintenance and other Capital Expenditures	1,802
Total Program Expenses	**60,916**
Admin Costs	621
Salaries & Wages	46,145
Travel Out of Pocket & Accommodation	674
Markerting Costs	484
Professional Cost	2,031
Total Operational Cost	**49,955**
TOTAL EXPENSES	**110,870**



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Instagram: @lakehub_community
WhatsApp chat : +254748902779

https://lakehub.co.ke/

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